# Sophia's Garden Plot and Ravi's Newsletter

Lesson 3 · Wednesday, December 2, 2026 · Your task list says which page to do and when.

## Part 1: Word Power

Write the best word or words from the bank in each blank. One choice is extra.

**Word bank:** numerator denominator common denominator equivalent fractions mixed number unlike denominators

**In 5/9: 1. 5 is the _____ 2. 9 is the _____**

**3. 1/2 and 4/8 name the same amount. They are _____.**

**4. 12 is a _____ for 1/4 and 1/6.**

**5. 2 1/3 is a _____.**

## Part 2: Add and subtract

Find a common denominator, rename, then add or subtract. Write each answer in simplest form. Use grid paper if you need more room.

**6. 1/6 + 3/5 = _____**

**7. 7/8 − 1/6 = _____**

**8. 3/4 + 2/3 = _____ (write it as a mixed number)**

**9. Which is bigger, 4/5 or 7/9? 4/5 = _____/45 7/9 = _____/45 Bigger: _____**

## Part 3: Sophia's new plot

Squash get 1/2 of a new plot, beans 1/5 and flowers 1/4. Work in the boxes. Simplest form.

Work for 10

Work for 11

Work for 12

**10. Squash and beans together use _____ of the plot.**

**11. Squash, beans and flowers together use _____ of the plot.**

**12. What fraction is left? _____ 13. More or less than 1/4? _____**

## Part 4: Ravi's Newsletter

Read each piece. Circle its author's purpose.

**14. Park cleanup notice: “Join us Saturday at 9am for the annual Maple Street Park cleanup! … we'll supply trash bags and water.”**

inform persuade entertain

**15. Joke Corner: “Why did the squirrel bring a ladder to the block party? Because he heard the snacks were on a whole new level!”**

inform persuade entertain

**16. Reader's letter: “Our neighborhood REALLY needs a crosswalk near the elementary school. … Please, everyone — sign the petition at the library.”**

inform persuade entertain

**17. “New this month: Ravi's family bakery is now open Saturdays 8am-2pm at 214 Maple Street. Try their cinnamon rolls, voted a neighborhood favorite three years running.” This spotlight has two purposes. Name both, and give one detail for each.**

**18. In one sentence, get neighbors to come to the cleanup. Use *please* or *should*.**

KCE PATHWAYS · GRADES 4–5 · UNIT 2: THE NEXT LEVEL · WEEK 8 · MATH

# Sophia's Garden Plot

Name: _____ Date: _____

PRE-LESSON WARM-UP · DO THIS BEFORE YOUR COMPUTER LESSON

## Before the Seeds Go In

*Sophia is helping design her neighborhood's community garden plot. Different vegetables each need a fraction of the space — but the fractions don't share a denominator. Before you meet her, warm up your fraction skills.*

**1** Match each word to its meaning. Draw a line, or write the matching letter next to each word.

| | |
|---|---|
| ___ **common denominator** | **A.** A smart, quick guess made by rounding first. |
| ___ **unlike denominators** | **B.** A denominator that two or more fractions can share. |
| ___ **equivalent fraction** | **C.** The bottom number in a fraction. |
| ___ **numerator** | **D.** A fraction that names the same amount, written with different numbers. |
| ___ **denominator** | **E.** Fractions whose bottom numbers are different. |
| ___ **estimate** | **F.** The top number in a fraction. |

**2** Find a common denominator for 1/2 and 1/3, then rewrite both as equivalent fractions using that denominator. Show your work.

**3** Have you ever helped plant a garden, or split up space for different things? Write 1–2 sentences about it.

KCE PATHWAYS · GRADES 4–5 · UNIT 2: THE NEXT LEVEL · WEEK 8 · MATH

# Sophia's Garden Plot

**Name:** _____ **Date:** _____

POST-LESSON CHALLENGE · DO THIS AFTER YOUR COMPUTER LESSON

## After the Garden Is Mapped

*Great work on today's lesson! Now show off what you learned about adding and comparing fractions with unlike denominators.*

**1** Sophia adds a THIRD vegetable: carrots take 1/6 of the plot, on top of tomatoes (1/3) and peppers (1/4). How much of the plot is now used? Show your common denominator work.

**2** Which is bigger: 3/8 or 2/5? Show your work using a common denominator.

**3** Extension: 5/6 − 1/4 = ? Show every step.

★ **Challenge:** Design your own garden plot! Pick three fractions with different denominators for three plants, add them together, and show all your work.

**Looking Ahead:** Next week we multiply DECIMALS at Elena's farmers market stand! Bring this sheet back to your next lesson.

KCE PATHWAYS · GRADES 4–5 · UNIT 2: THE NEXT LEVEL · WEEK 8 · READING

# Ravi's Newsletter

Name: _____ Date: _____

PRE-LESSON WARM-UP · DO THIS BEFORE YOUR COMPUTER LESSON

## Before the Newsletter Goes Out

*Ravi helps put together his neighborhood's monthly newsletter. Every piece in it is written for a different reason. Before you sort them, warm up your reading brain.*

**1** Match each word to its meaning. Draw a line, or write the matching letter next to each word.

| | |
|---|---|
| ___ **author's purpose** | **A.** Specific facts or details that support a point. |
| ___ **inform** | **B.** The reason a writer chose to write a piece — usually to inform, persuade, or entertain. |
| ___ **persuade** | **C.** The perspective a writer or speaker sees a topic from. |
| ___ **entertain** | **D.** To convince someone to think or act a certain way. |
| ___ **point of view** | **E.** To give facts or explain something clearly. |
| ___ **evidence** | **F.** To amuse or interest the reader, often through humor or story. |

**2** Read this sentence: “Recycling saves our planet — start today!” Is this meant to inform, persuade, or entertain? Explain your answer.

**3** Think of something you've read — an ad, a joke, a news article. What was its purpose? Write 1–2 sentences.

KCE PATHWAYS · GRADES 4–5 · UNIT 2: THE NEXT LEVEL · WEEK 8 · READING

# Ravi's Newsletter

**Name:** _____ **Date:** _____

POST-LESSON CHALLENGE · DO THIS AFTER YOUR COMPUTER LESSON

## After Sorting the Sections

*Great work on today's lesson! Now show off what you learned about identifying an author's purpose.*

**1** List the four newsletter pieces from the lesson and the purpose (inform, persuade, or entertain) of each one.

**2** Explain in 2–3 sentences why the bakery spotlight piece blends TWO purposes at once.

**3** Why does knowing an author's purpose help you read more carefully? Explain your thinking in 2–3 sentences.

★ **Challenge:** Write THREE short pieces of your own about the same topic — one to inform, one to persuade, and one to entertain.

**Looking Ahead:** Next week we put TWO different sources together into one bigger idea — that's called synthesizing! Bring this sheet back to your next lesson.

KCE PATHWAYS · GRADES 4-5 · UNIT 1: FIRST STEPS · WEEK 2 · SOCIAL STUDIES

# Life in America Before 1492 (I)

**Name:** _____ **Date:** _____

PRE-LESSON WARM-UP · DO THIS BEFORE YOUR COMPUTER LESSON

## What Do I Already Know About Life Before 1492?

*Answer what you can. There are no wrong guesses on this page!*

1. Who lived in North America before 1492? Write anything you know.

2. Predict: How could a city be built 1,000 years ago without machines?

3. Draw what you think a city or town in North America looked like 1,000 years ago. Label two parts.

4. Circle one: Before 1492, North America was home to **a few** / **hundreds of** nations. What makes you think so?

5. What is one question you wonder about people who lived before 1492?

KCE PATHWAYS · GRADES 4-5 · UNIT 1: FIRST STEPS · WEEK 2 · SOCIAL STUDIES

# Life in America Before 1492 (I)

**Name:** _____ **Date:** _____

POST-LESSON CHALLENGE · DO THIS AFTER YOUR COMPUTER LESSON

## Show What I Learned

*Use evidence from the lesson in your answers.*

1. Describe Cahokia. Use at least two facts (where it was, when, or what its people built).

2. Explain the Great Law of Peace. Who brought it, and what power did clan mothers have?

3. Compare: How do we know about Cahokia, and how do we know about the Great Law? Why are the kinds of evidence different?

4. Name one object that traveled far in a trade network and where it came from.

★ **Challenge:** An old book calls North America before 1492 “an empty wilderness.” Write two pieces of evidence from today's lesson that prove it wrong.

**Looking Ahead:** Next week we visit Tenochtitlan, the Inca roads, Pacific Northwest nations, and the West African empire of Mali under Mansa Musa. Bring this question: How were these places connected to the wider world?